

Promotion and Assessment Guide

Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order

Schoolmaster Promotion and Assessment Guide

Assessment Pillars All promotions should be judged on five pillars: knowledge, judgment, service, character, and communication. Knowledge measures the student's grasp of timeline, offices, people, causes, and historical meaning. Judgment measures the student's ability to separate fact from myth. Service measures dependable charitable contribution. Character measures honesty, humility, discipline, and respect. Communication measures written and oral clarity.

Promotion Standards Squire to Sergeant at age eighteen should require successful completion of the youth course, attendance, reading log, service threshold, written exam, oral interview, and signature of adult commitments.

New Member to Sergeant should require completion of the adult school, a passing written score, an essay, service hours, and a Sergeant Board interview.

Sergeant to Knight should require advanced reading, stronger writing, a teaching presentation, leadership in service, and a formal oral defense.

Knight to Lieutenant, Captain, and Major should require demonstrated instructional ability, mentoring, recordkeeping, course leadership, and curriculum fidelity.

Question Bank — Squires

Multiple Choice 1. What major event happened before the Templars were formed? A. The Renaissance. B. The First Crusade. C. The Reformation. D. The Black Death. Correct answer: B. 2. Why were the first Templars formed? A. To become kings. B. To build ships. C. To protect pilgrims. D. To write laws. Correct answer: C. 3. Who is most closely linked with the founding of the order? A. Philip IV. B. Hugh de Payns. C. Richard III. D. Charlemagne. Correct answer: B. 4. Where did the early Templars receive headquarters? A. Rome. B. London. C. Temple Mount in Jerusalem. D. Venice. Correct answer: C. 5. Which church gathering approved the order? A. Council of Trent. B. Council of Troyes. C. Council of Pisa. D. Council of Nicaea. Correct answer: B. 6. Which pope granted the order major privileges in 1139? A. Innocent II. B. Urban II. C. Gregory VII. D. Leo III. Correct answer: A. 7. Which city's fall weakened the order's original military purpose? A. Paris. B. Acre. C. Lisbon. D. Antioch. Correct answer: B. 8. Who ordered the arrest of the Templars in France in 1307? A. Baldwin II. B. Jacques de Molay. C. Philip IV. D. Bernard of Clairvaux. Correct answer: C. 9. Which pope suppressed the order in 1312? A. Urban II. B. Clement V. C. Innocent III. D. Gregory I. Correct answer: B. 10. Who was the last Grand Master? A. Hugh de Payns. B. Bernard of Clairvaux. C. Jacques de Molay. D. Geoffrey of Anjou. Correct answer: C.

Squire Discussion Prompts Why do you think protecting travelers was treated as a holy duty? Why is it important to tell the difference between history and legend? What can a young member learn from the fall of a once-powerful order? Why should a

modern order focus on charity and service instead of power?

Question Bank — Adult New Members and Sergeants

Multiple Choice 1. Which best describes the situation after the First Crusade? A. Pilgrims were completely safe. B. Crusader states were established but remained vulnerable. C. France controlled Jerusalem directly. D. The Templars had already been founded. Correct answer: B. 2. Hugh de Payns founded the order primarily to: A. Control trade in Italy. B. Defend pilgrims and Holy Land routes. C. Overthrow kings. D. Replace the papacy. Correct answer: B. 3. The Council of Troyes is important because it: A. dissolved the order. B. condemned the Crusades. C. approved the order. D. moved the Templars to France. Correct answer: C. 4. Bernard of Clairvaux is associated with the Templars because he: A. arrested them. B. defended and promoted the new knighthood ideal. C. led the Hospitallers. D. became Grand Master. Correct answer: B. 5. Omne Datum Optimum is most associated with: A. major papal privileges for the order. B. the execution of de Molay. C. the loss of Acre. D. the founding of the Hospitallers. Correct answer: A. 6. Which was not one of the major historical classes of Templar membership? A. Knight. B. Sergeant. C. Chaplain. D. Duke. Correct answer: D. 7. Which factor most weakened the Templars' original mission? A. Printing presses. B. Fall of Acre in 1291. C. Discovery of America. D. Norman conquest of England. Correct answer: B. 8. Why did Philip IV target the Templars? A. Only for religious reasons. B. Only because they were poor. C. Likely for a mix of fear, politics, and money. D. Because they had conquered France. Correct answer: C. 9. What happened in 1312? A. The order was founded. B. The order was formally suppressed. C. Jerusalem fell in the First Crusade. D. de Molay became Grand Master. Correct answer: B. 10. What happened in 1314? A. The Council of Troyes met. B. The order gained tax privileges. C. Jacques de Molay was executed. D. Acre was captured. Correct answer: C.

Adult Discussion Prompts Was the fall of the Templars caused more by politics, money, or scandal? Why do successful organizations become vulnerable when they grow wealthy and autonomous? What is the difference between admiration for the Templars and mythmaking about them? How should this Order study the Templars without falsely claiming to be them?

Question Bank — Sergeant to Knight

Multiple Choice 1. The Templars' early headquarters were located in: A. Constantinople. B. the Al-Aqsa and Temple Mount complex in Jerusalem. C. Antioch. D. Rome. Correct answer: B. 2. Which office was second in command? A. Prior. B. Treasurer. C. Seneschal. D. Draper. Correct answer: C. 3. Which office handled administration and provisions? A. Preceptor or Commander. B. Prior. C. Marshal. D. Chaplain. Correct answer: A. 4. Which office was the chief military officer? A. Treasurer. B. Marshal. C. Draper. D. Prior. Correct answer: B. 5. Which best describes papal privileges after 1139? A. The order became subject to every local bishop. B. The order lost all tax rights. C. The order gained major autonomy under the pope. D. The order was moved to Paris. Correct answer: C. 6. Which event came first? A. Arrests in France. B. Fall of Acre. C. Council of Troyes. D. Execution of de Molay. Correct answer: C. 7. Which claim is the strongest historical explanation for the order's

destruction? A. A single battle destroyed them. B. A mixture of political pressure, financial motives, and scandal. C. They voluntarily dissolved. D. They all moved to England. Correct answer: B. 8. After suppression, many Templar assets were transferred mainly to: A. The Teutonic Knights only. B. The Hospitallers. C. The English crown. D. Venice. Correct answer: B.

Knight Discussion Prompts What internal strengths made the Templars effective, and what internal weaknesses made them vulnerable? How can a modern order borrow structure from history without reenacting medieval power culture? Why should a Knight in this Order be expected to teach younger members? Which is more dangerous to an order: outside enemies or mission drift from within?

Question Bank — Knight Officers

Multiple Choice 1. Which of the following is most historically responsible leadership? A. Repeating legends as facts because they inspire people. B. Teaching students how to weigh sources carefully. C. Avoiding difficult history. D. Ignoring the order's suppression. Correct answer: B. 2. Which statement is most accurate? A. The Templars disappeared because they lost one duel. B. The Templars were founded after the fall of Acre. C. The Templars were approved early, privileged by the papacy, then later suppressed under pressure. D. The Templars ruled all Europe. Correct answer: C. 3. Which office historically handled finance? A. Treasurer. B. Marshal. C. Prior. D. Turcopolier. Correct answer: A. 4. Which question best demonstrates good source criticism? A. Does this story sound exciting? B. Who wrote this, when, and why? C. Can I use this in a ceremony? D. Will this impress recruits? Correct answer: B. 5. Which of the following should a modern Schoolmaster reject? A. Timelines and maps. B. Primary and secondary reading. C. False claims of lineage to boost prestige. D. Structured oral exams. Correct answer: C. 6. Which quality is most important for a Major-grade educational officer? A. Loud ceremonial presence. B. Ability to preserve standards and train instructors. C. Owning expensive regalia. D. Memorizing only legends. Correct answer: B.

Officer Discussion Prompts If a member teaches a popular myth as fact, how should the school correct it without humiliation? What makes an order legitimate: titles, pageantry, service, scholarship, or governance? How do you preserve inspiration while still teaching hard history? Why should promotion boards include both moral and historical evaluation?

Reading by Section and Rank Squires should begin with school handouts, timeline sheets, simple biographies, and short supervised excerpts. Adult recruits should begin with Dan Jones and Helen Nicholson. Sergeants preparing for Knight should add Malcolm Barber and selected translated sources. Officers should add Bernard of Clairvaux and myth-versus-history reading such as Michael Haag.

Reading recommendations supported by Cambridge University Press, Profile Books, Fordham Sourcebook, Penguin Random House, and Arc Humanities Press resources identified in research for this curriculum.